The Future of Organisations & Work

Exam revision and preparation

Three-hour closing session

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Session map

12:00-12:15	Exam overview and initial questions
12:15-1:00	Motivation, Emotion, Decision Making
1:00-1:10	Break
1:10-2:10	Individual Differences, Groups and Teams, Conflict and Negotiation, Diversity and Inclusion
2:10-2:20	Break
2:20-2:50	Leadership, Organizational Structure and Change
2:50-3:00	Exam strategy and wrap-up



Exam overview

2 hours: attempt any four questions from six

- Each question addresses a different class topic.
- All questions carry equal marks.
- Strong answers are precise in explaining theory and applying it.
- Answer every part and follow the command words.
- Use specific examples to support theory, not replace it.

How each topic round works

4 minutes	Five Quiz questions
3 minutes	Answers and brief corrections
4 minutes	Read and decode a long-form exam question
3 minutes	Model answer structure
1 minute	One focused question

The poll retrieves the building blocks. The exam plan shows how to organize them into an answer.

Initial exam questions

What would be most useful to clarify before we begin?

Question choice • command words • timing • structure • use of examples

[Insert Poll Everywhere link or QR code]



1. Motivation: retrieval quiz 1 of 2

1 **Which definition best captures motivation?**

A. A stable personality trait B. The direction, intensity and persistence of effort C. Employee satisfaction D. Financial reward

2 **Which theory separates hygiene factors from motivators?**

A. Maslow B. Expectancy theory C. Two-Factor Theory D. Goal-setting theory

3 **Which three needs sit at the centre of Self-Determination Theory?**

A. Pay, security and status B. Autonomy, competence and relatedness C. Equity, voice and explanation D. Effort, performance and reward

1. Motivation: retrieval quiz 2 of 2

4 **A target of 25 presentations per month improves speed but reduces checking. What does this show?**

A. Goals direct attention and may neglect unmeasured outcomes B. Specific goals never work C. Pay is always a hygiene factor D. Employees lack belonging

5 **Employees doubt that strong performance will lead to promotion. Which expectancy link is weak?**

A. Expectancy B. Instrumentality C. Valence D. Relatedness

1. Motivation: answers

1. B Motivation concerns where effort goes, how much effort is exerted and how long it continues.

2. C Hygiene factors can reduce dissatisfaction, while achievement, recognition and responsibility can create satisfaction.

3. B SDT focuses on the quality of motivation produced when autonomy, competence and relatedness are supported.

4. A Specific goals focus behaviour, but narrow measures can encourage quantity at the expense of quality.

5. B Instrumentality is the belief that performance will produce the promised outcome.

2. Emotion: retrieval quiz 1 of 2

1 **What most clearly distinguishes an emotion from a mood?**

A. Emotions are always positive B. Emotions are brief and usually linked to an event C. Moods are more intense D. Moods have obvious causes

2 **An adviser feels angry but displays calm concern. What concept applies?**

A. Emotional labour B. Escalation of commitment C. Deep-level diversity D. Instrumentality

3 **What is surface acting?**

A. Changing the situation B. Changing inner feelings C. Displaying the required emotion without changing what is felt D. Ignoring display rules

2. Emotion: retrieval quiz 2 of 2

4 **In Affective Events Theory, what connects a workplace event to later attitudes or behaviour?**

A. An emotional reaction B. A personality test C. Formal structure D. A financial reward

5 **Recognising that a colleague is anxious mainly demonstrates which EI element?**

A. Appraisal of others' emotions B. Regulation of own emotions C. Utilization of emotion D. Appraisal of own emotions

2. Emotion: answers

1. B Emotions are usually shorter and event-focused. Moods are more diffuse and may lack a clear trigger.

2. A The role requires the employee to manage displayed emotion as part of the job.

3. C Surface acting changes the outward display and can create emotional dissonance.

4. A Events trigger emotional reactions, which influence judgement, behaviour and accumulated work attitudes.

5. A The person is noticing and interpreting another person's emotional cues.

3. Decision Making: retrieval quiz 1 of 2

1 **Which assumption belongs to the rational decision-making model?**

A. Decision-makers accept the first adequate option B. Preferences and alternatives can be identified and compared C. Emotion replaces analysis D. Information is always interpreted intuitively

2 **Choosing the first option that meets minimum requirements illustrates:**

A. Optimization B. Bounded rationality and satisficing C. Confirmation bias D. Escalation of commitment

3 **A manager relies on a first price estimate when judging every later proposal. Which bias applies?**

A. Availability B. Anchoring C. Framing D. Confirmation

3. Decision Making: retrieval quiz 2 of 2

4 **A recent cyberattack makes executives greatly overestimate its general likelihood. Which heuristic applies?**

A. Availability B. Sunk cost C. Loss framing D. Intuition

5 **A firm continues a failing project because it has already spent €5 million. Which bias applies?**

A. Confirmation bias B. Escalation of commitment C. Gain framing D. Anchoring

3. Decision Making: answers

1. B The rational model assumes clear criteria, available alternatives and consistent comparison.

2. B Limited time, information and cognitive capacity encourage a satisfactory rather than optimal choice.

3. B The first value becomes an anchor that pulls later judgements toward it.

4. A Events that are vivid or easily recalled feel more frequent or probable.

5. B Irrecoverable past investment influences a decision that should depend on future costs and benefits.

Rational decision-making model

A model of how individuals should behave to maximize an outcome.

Key assumptions

- Complete information is available.
- All relevant options can be identified without bias.
- The option with the highest utility is chosen.

Example: A procurement team compares every eligible AI platform against agreed cost, accuracy, security and service criteria, then selects the highest-scoring option.

Bounded rationality

A simplified process that captures essential features without representing full complexity.

Key assumptions

- Information-processing capacity is limited—even when information is available.
- Complex problems cannot be solved with full rationality.
- Decision makers simplify, search sequentially and often satisfice.

Example: Under time pressure, a manager reviews applicants in order and appoints the first person who meets an acceptable skills threshold.

Intuitive decision making

An unconscious process created from distilled experience. This can lead to unconscious bias and be expressed in heuristics.

Key features

- Occurs outside conscious thought.
- Uses holistic associations between pieces of information.
- Is fast and affectively charged.
- Works best when experience is relevant and patterns are learnable.

Example: An experienced cybersecurity analyst senses danger in an unusual activity pattern and escalates before formal indicators are conclusive.

10-minute break

Return for Individual Differences

4. Individual Differences: retrieval quiz 1 of 2

1 **Which definition best describes personality?**

A. A temporary mood B. Relatively enduring patterns of thought, emotion and behaviour C. Job knowledge D. A fixed predictor of performance

2 **Which item is not part of the Big Five?**

A. Openness B. Agreeableness C. Self-esteem D. Conscientiousness

3 **An extravert thrives in a networking role but gains little advantage in solitary analysis. This shows:**

A. Trait activation and person-environment interaction B. Personality is unreliable C. Extraversion causes leadership D. Strong situations amplify every trait

4. Individual Differences: retrieval quiz 2 of 2

4 **Which set contains the four core self-evaluations?**

A. Self-esteem, generalized self-efficacy, locus of control, emotional stability B. Openness, status, cohesion, confidence C. Autonomy, competence, relatedness, fairness D. Ability, motivation, opportunity, identity

5 **Which is the strongest criticism of using one personality score as a hiring cut-off?**

A. Personality never predicts behaviour B. Context, validity, response distortion and adverse interpretation matter C. All tests are clinical tools D. Teams require identical personalities

4. Individual Differences: answers

1. B Personality describes relatively stable patterns, while situations still shape how traits appear.

2. C Self-esteem belongs to core self-evaluations rather than the Big Five.

3. A Work demands provide cues and opportunities that activate some traits more than others.

4. A Core self-evaluations reflect fundamental evaluations of one's worth, capability and control.

5. B Testing can add information, but broad scores require validated measures, job relevance and cautious interpretation.

5. Groups and Teams: retrieval quiz 1 of 2

1 **What distinguishes a team from a group most clearly?**

A. A team always has more members B. A team combines complementary skills around a specific shared purpose and mutual accountability C. A group has no interaction D. A team has no formal leader

2 **A hybrid employee receives incompatible demands from a project lead and functional manager. Which property is central?**

A. Role conflict B. Cohesion C. Group size D. Surface diversity

3 **Senior members dominate discussion despite having less relevant evidence. Which property is distorting the team?**

A. Status B. Size C. Relatedness D. Formalization

5. Groups and Teams: retrieval quiz 2 of 2

4 **High cohesion is most likely to improve performance when:**

A. The group is very large B. Performance norms support the task C. Everyone has the same personality D. Conflict is prohibited

5 **Training, resources and leadership sit in which part of the team-effectiveness model?**

A. Context B. Composition C. Processes D. Diversity

5. Groups and Teams: answers

1. B Teams create stronger task interdependence and collective responsibility. Not every group needs to become a team.

2. A The employee faces incompatible expectations attached to overlapping roles.

3. A Status affects attention and influence and may prevent task-relevant information from being used.

4. B Cohesion strengthens commitment to the group's norms, whether those norms support or undermine performance.

5. A Context asks whether the wider organization enables the team through resources, information, rewards and support.

Context enables—or constrains—the team

- Adequate resources
- Leadership and structure
- Culture or climate
- Performance evaluation and rewards
- Technology and virtuality
- Interdependence and norms
- Crises and extreme contexts

Robbins & Judge (2024)

Composition asks whether the team is well staffed

- Abilities and teamwork skills
- Personality
- Allocation of roles
- Diversity
- Size
- Member flexibility
- Member preferences for teamwork

Robbins & Judge (2024)

Processes turn potential into performance

- Common purpose
- Motivation and aligned goals
- Team efficacy
- Conflict
- Cohesion
- Social loafing

These processes matter especially when teams are large or highly interdependent.

Robbins & Judge (2024)

6. Conflict and Negotiation: retrieval quiz 1 of 2

1 **When does conflict begin?**

A. Whenever people disagree B. When one party perceives that another has negatively affected something important C. Only when emotions become visible D. When a manager intervenes

2 **Disagreement about who should complete a task is primarily which type of conflict?**

A. Task B. Process C. Relationship D. Status

3 **Which conflict approach combines high concern for self with high concern for others?**

A. Avoiding B. Yielding C. Collaborating D. Forcing

6. Conflict and Negotiation: retrieval quiz 2 of 2

4 **When may avoiding be appropriate?**

A. When an urgent safety decision is required B. When the issue is trivial or emotions need time to cool C. Whenever the manager has authority D. When both parties need full satisfaction immediately

5 **A position is what a party says it wants. An interest is:**

A. The punishment it threatens B. The underlying need or concern C. The final contract D. The other party's opening offer

6. Conflict and Negotiation: answers

1. B Conflict depends on perceived interference with something the party values.

2. B Process conflict concerns how work, responsibility or resources should be allocated.

3. C Collaboration seeks to address both parties' underlying concerns, although it requires time and information.

4. B Avoiding can be useful temporarily when the issue is minor, information is missing or emotions are too high.

5. B Exploring interests creates more possibilities than bargaining only over stated positions.

Choose a conflict approach to fit the situation

Yield/accommodate — protect the relationship when the issue matters more to the other party.

Avoid — delay when the issue is minor, information is missing or emotions are too high.

Force/compete — act decisively when speed, safety or principle requires it.

Compromise — find a workable middle ground.

Problem-solve/collaborate — integrate interests when the issue matters to both sides.

No single approach is always best.

7. Diversity and Inclusion: retrieval quiz 1 of 2

1 **Which is an example of deep-level diversity?**

A. Age B. Visible disability C. Values and perspectives learned through interaction D. Clothing

2 **What distinguishes inclusion from representation?**

A. Inclusion concerns only numbers B. Inclusion concerns participation, influence, opportunity and belonging C. Representation removes all bias D. Inclusion requires similarity

3 **Which pathway explains how diversity can improve decisions?**

A. Social categorization B. Information processing and learning C. Escalation of commitment D. Emotional dissonance

7. Diversity and Inclusion: retrieval quiz 2 of 2

4 **Removing an employee from a client call because of an untested assumption about their accent is primarily:**

A. Exclusion B. Sexual harassment C. Deep acting D. Compromise

5 **Which practice provides the strongest evidence of inclusion?**

A. Publishing a diversity statement B. Hiring one person from an underrepresented group C. Auditing voice, assignments, advancement and complaint outcomes D. Removing all discussion of difference

7. Diversity and Inclusion: answers

1. C Deep-level attributes become known through interaction. Surface-level characteristics are more readily observed.

2. B Representation asks who is present. Inclusion asks whose contributions matter and who can access opportunities.

3. B Different knowledge and perspectives can expand information and challenge unquestioned assumptions.

4. A The employee loses an opportunity because of a potentially stereotyped judgement.

5. C Inclusive claims require evidence from formal systems, outcomes and employees' lived experience.

Inclusion requires a system, not a single intervention

Relationships: common identity and meaningful contact.

Entry: inclusive recruitment, selection and role allocation.

Capability: training, feedback, mentoring and development.

Environment: culture, climate, leadership signals and accountability.

A strong approach aligns all four; one isolated initiative is easy to undermine.

10-minute break

Return for Leadership

8. Leadership: retrieval quiz 1 of 2

1 **Which definition best fits the module's approach to leadership?**

A. A trait possessed by senior managers B. A relational influence process that mobilizes group members toward shared goals C. The use of formal authority D. Individual charisma

2 **LMX theory focuses on:**

A. Differentiated relationship quality between leader and follower B. Universal leader traits C. National culture D. Formal structure

3 **Which set contains the Four I's of transformational leadership?**

A. Influence, inspiration, intellectual stimulation, individualized consideration B. Integrity, inclusion, innovation, intuition C. Interest, identity, instrumentality, influence D. Information, incentives, inspection, intervention

Answer on Poll Everywhere before the answers appear.

8. Leadership: retrieval quiz 2 of 2

4 **A leader specifies a target and provides a reward when it is met. Which approach is most evident?**

A. Transactional leadership B. Servant leadership C. Authentic leadership D. Charismatic attribution

5 **Which 'zombie leadership' assumption is challenged by shared leadership?**

A. Only leaders can lead B. Conflict is always harmful C. Personality never matters D. All teams need cohesion

Answer on Poll Everywhere before the answers appear.

8. Leadership: answers

1. B Leadership depends on leaders, followers, relationships, group identity and context.

2. A LMX examines the quality and consequences of different leader-member relationships.

3. A The full labels are idealized influence, inspirational motivation, intellectual stimulation and individualized consideration.

4. A Contingent reward creates an explicit performance-outcome exchange.

5. A Leadership can emerge from different members according to expertise, relationships and task needs.



Leadership- a history of great men

- Great Person Theory- leaders are special people
  - “For, as I take it, Universal History, the history of what man has accomplished in this world, is at bottom the History of the **Great Men** who have worked here” (Carlyle, 1840).
- What this looks like now…



AI Wizard Sam Altman Shows What Real Leadership Is. His Bosses Were Clueless

By Simon Constable, Former Contributor. © Author | Broadcaster | Journalist | Commentator | Speaker.

Published Nov 24, 2023, 10:02am EST, Updated Nov 29, 2023, 01:11pm EST

This article is more than 2 years old.

Five assumptions that keep heroic leadership alive- **Zombie Leadership**

1. Leadership is all about leaders.
2. Only leaders can lead.
3. Leaders possess qualities that ordinary people lack.
4. Group success should be attributed to leaders.
5. History is the story of great men.

These assumptions remain attractive—but distort selection, development, recognition and accountability.

(Haslam, Alvesson & Reicher, 2024)

9. Organizational Structure and Change: retrieval quiz 1 of 2

1 **Organizational structure describes how work is:**

A. Motivated and rewarded B. Formally divided, grouped and coordinated C. Emotionally experienced D. Negotiated informally

2 **A manager directly supervises 22 employees. Which design element does this illustrate?**

A. Formalization B. Span of control C. Departmentalization D. Work specialization

3 **Head office sets every store's prices. This is an example of:**

A. Decentralization B. Centralization C. Low formalization D. Team structure

Answer on Poll Everywhere before the answers appear.

9. Organizational Structure and Change: retrieval quiz 2 of 2

4 **Which combination is most characteristic of an organic design?**

A. High specialization, narrow spans and centralized authority B. Flexible roles, lateral communication and decentralized decisions C. Rigid departments and extensive rules D. One best procedure for every task

5 **In Lewin's model, what is the main purpose of refreezing?**

A. Announcing the need for change B. Stabilizing useful changes through systems, norms and reinforcement C. Identifying every alternative D. Returning to the old structure

Answer on Poll Everywhere before the answers appear.

9. Organizational Structure and Change: answers

1. B Structure allocates tasks, groups work and establishes coordination and authority.

2. B Span of control is the number of employees who report directly to a manager.

3. B Important decision authority remains concentrated at a senior or central level.

4. B Organic designs support adaptation through flexible roles and distributed communication and authority.

5. B Refreezing embeds the new pattern so that it can persist rather than remaining a temporary initiative.

A reliable approach to long-form questions

1	**Decode**	Underline every command word and content requirement.
2	**Allocate**	Divide time and marks across every part of the question.
3	**Plan**	Create a short paragraph map before writing.
4	**Develop**	Explain theory, apply it and evaluate it in each main section.
5	**Conclude**	Answer the question directly with a qualified judgement.

Description earns limited credit when the question requires application, comparison or critical evaluation.

Personal revision plan

1. My three strongest topics are...
2. The two topics requiring the most work are...
3. One distinction I still confuse is...
4. One theory I need to practise applying is...
5. My next concrete revision action is...



Select carefully

Plan before writing

Apply and evaluate

Questions?

